Glucagon

FORM Powder and solvent for solution, containing 1mg glucagon (Hypokit)

INDICATION Treatment of persistent hypoglycaemia.

a) Hypoglycaemia associated with diabetes
b) Endogenous hyperinsulinism

DOSE RANGE

a) Hypoglycaemia associated with diabetes

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
< 1month	20micrograms/kg	STAT	IM, SC or IV
1 – 6months	500micrograms	STAT	IM, SC or IV

b) Endogenous hyperinsulinism

AGE	DOSE RANGE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
< 1month	200micrograms/kg (to maximum of 1mg) 5 - 20 micrograms/kg/hour (higher doses must be discussed with the endocrine consultant)	STAT Continuous infusion	IM, IV IV Infusion
1 – 6months	1mg 2.5-10micrograms/kg/hour	STAT Continuous infusion	IM, IV IV Infusion

PRESCRIPTION OF CONTINUOUS INFUSION

1.25mg/kg in 50ml infusion fluid
This gives:-
- 10 microgram/kg/hour at 0.4ml/hour

RECONSTITUTION Reconstitute powder in vial with solvent in syringe to give glucagon 1mg/ml.

DILUTION

For intramuscular, subcutaneous or intravenous injection dilute to an appropriate volume for administration using glucose 5%.

For continuous Infusion: Using reconstituted 1mg in 1ml injection
1.25 x wt (kg) is the number of ml of 1mg/ml to be diluted up to 50ml total with infusion fluid (equivalent to **1.25mg/kg in 50ml**)

METHOD OF ADMINISTRATION By continuous intravenous infusion, flow rate adjusted according to the baby's response (see prescription section for details).

DO NOT FILTER THE INFUSION

COMPATIBILITY

Solution compatibility	Glucose 5%
Solution incompatibility	Do not run with infusion fluids containing calcium ions (e.g. Parenteral Nutrition) as this causes precipitation of the glucagon
IV Line compatibility	No information
IV Line incompatibility	No information

Neonatal

NEONATAL West of Scotland Drug Monographs
Parenteral Route

THIS LIST IS NOT EXHAUSTIVE PLEASE CONTACT PHARMACY FOR FURTHER INFORMATION ON COMPATIBILITY WITH ANY MEDICINES NOT INCLUDED

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS
See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children
.

FURTHER INFORMATION Discard if particles or fibrils (viscous appearance) are present in reconstituted injection.
Intravenous administration is unlicensed but accepted practice.
Glucagon has a low pH and may cause venous irritation/tissue damage in cases of extravasation. If central venous access is unavailable, administer via large peripheral vein and monitor insertion site closely.

STORAGE **Store in a refrigerator** *(can be stored for 18 months up to 25 degrees)*
Protect from light

PH 2.5 - 3.5

LICENSED STATUS Licensed for this indication (IV infusion unlicensed).

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines:

Consult local policy if applicable

Document Number:	007	Supersedes:	006
Prepared by/Checked By	Olivia Scales/Frances Lowrie/Susan Kafka	Final Approval By	WoS Neonatal Pharmacist Group
Date prepared	September 2026	Review Date	February 2028

Administer reconstituted solutions immediately.
All vials, ampoules and infusion bags are for single use only unless otherwise stated.

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice please contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department